

“HAVE” — THREE DIFFERENT JOBS

Causative Have vs. Have To vs. Possession

The same word “have” does three unrelated jobs in English. Only ONE of them is the causative verb we've been studying.

Type	Pattern	Example + Meaning
1. Causative Have	<i>have + person/thing + base verb OR past participle</i>	“I have my car fixed.” — Someone ELSE performs the action for you.
2. Have To	<i>have to + base verb</i>	“I have to leave early.” — YOUR OWN obligation. No second person involved.
3. Possession	<i>have + noun (no verb after)</i>	“I have a doctor's appointment.” — You simply hold/possess something. Nothing is being done in this sentence.

The One-Question Test

Is a SECOND PERSON doing an action, described inside this sentence?

YES → Causative	NO, it's about ME → Have To	NO, nothing is done → Possession
“The mechanic fixes it.”	“I must leave.”	Just a fact you hold/own.

Real-Life Tampa Examples

- Causative: “I had my brakes checked before the trip.”
- Have To: “I have to renew my registration before Friday.”
- Possession: “I have a 2:00 appointment at the DMV.”

PRACTICE

Causative Have vs. Have To vs. Possession

Part A: Identify the Type

Label each sentence: C (Causative), H (Have To), or P (Possession).

#	Sentence	Type
1	I have to pick up my daughter at 3:00.	_____
2	I have my hair cut every six weeks.	_____
3	She has a dentist appointment on Tuesday.	_____
4	We have to submit the paperwork by Friday.	_____
5	He had the plumber fix the leak yesterday.	_____
6	I have a meeting with my landlord tomorrow.	_____
7	They have their house cleaned every other week.	_____
8	You have to renew your permit before it expires.	_____

Part B: Fix the Confusion

1. **WRONG:** “I have to fix my car” (but a mechanic did it, not you) — what should it say?

2. **CHECK:** “I have my appointment” (just a fact, nothing being done) — is this sentence fine as-is, or does it need fixing?

3. **WRONG:** “I have cut my hair” (meaning: a stylist did it) — what should it say?

Part C: Write Your Own

1. Write a **CAUSATIVE** sentence about a car service.

2. Write a **HAVE TO** sentence about something you must do this week.

3. Write a **POSSESSION** sentence about an appointment or event on your calendar.

4. Write a **CAUSATIVE** sentence about a home repair.

5. Write a **HAVE TO** sentence about a work or school deadline.

TEACHER ANSWER KEY — DO NOT DISTRIBUTE TO STUDENTS

Part A Answers

1. H 2. C 3. P 4. H 5. C 6. P 7. C 8. H

Part B Answers (model corrections)

1. “I had my car fixed” (or “I had a mechanic fix my car”) — someone else performed the action.
2. Correct as written — “I have my appointment” is possession; no fix needed unless the intent was to say something was done (e.g., “I have my appointment scheduled”).
3. “I had my hair cut” (or “I had a stylist cut my hair”) — someone else performed the action.

Part C: Monitor for Correct Structure

Answers will vary. Confirm: Causative sentences name or imply a second person performing the action; Have To sentences describe personal obligation with no second-person actor; Possession sentences simply state something held/scheduled with no action performed.

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